

my finances was only step one. Step two was minimising the impact of this behaviour through working with a freaking good therapist, understanding my Financial Phenotype and creating a Money Environment and habits that are right for me. What I know is that if you're prepared to acknowledge how you act, how you behave, and to seek help—I promise you that you can do something about it too.

What I want to say here, gently and lovingly, is that if you are engaging in behaviour that you know or suspect occurs because you haven't addressed emotional issues, please seek help. I know I mentioned this above but I'm mentioning it again because it's so important. This can be professional financial counselling if you're in debt, but I highly encourage you to also speak to a trained therapist.

There's no shame in admitting you're not coping.

Trust me.

Chances are your compulsive or addictive behaviours make you deeply ashamed, but if you choose to do something to change those behaviours, they don't have to define you or trap you.

If you suspect you suffer from financial compulsion or addiction, be assured that this issue is real and rife in our modern society and choose, like me, to seek help.

If you're in debt as a result of addiction, speak to a debt counsellor. In Australia, you can call the National Debt Helpline (ndh.org.au) on 1800 007 007. There are also organisations such as Good Shepherd Microfinance (goodshepherdmicrofinance.org.au) who offer no-interest loans and fair and affordable financial programs to people on low incomes. Or you might seek help from a registered therapist. In Australia, try the Australian Counselling Association (theaca.net.au) and the Psychotherapy and Counselling Federation of Australia (pacfa.org.au). If you live outside Australia, you should be able to find registered therapists online via professional organisations in your country.